

BIG GOES SMALL

Television lost its poor cousin tag in 2008. In 2000, Amitabh Bachchan decided to ask the right questions on *Kaun Banega Crorepati* because the box office gave him all the wrong answers. But this year, multiple channels, new and old, throwing mega bucks made the tube a holiday home for film industry's reigning biggies. Between films, *khatron ka khiladi* Akshay Kumar thrilled, trying to add some dum, Salman Khan (top) shri-illed and Shah Rukh Khan, with some help from five over-enthusiastic kids, grilled. Even the women decided it was time to cash in outside of 70 mm. Sushmita Sen, minus films and plus two dozen pounds, sat on the judges' chair to play some dancing games in *Ek Khiladi Ek Haseena*. The TRPs went up, as did their bank balances.



GOLDEN GIRL

In a year when Hindi films had a disastrous run, **Katrina Kaif** won the *Race*. Awkward accent apart, Kaif played the cooing damsel in distress to perfection with another money spinner, *Singh is Kingg*, making her the uncrowned queen. She became the most Googled Indian actor, charged Rs 1 crore for a New Year gig (that was later cancelled) and endorsed over six brands. Now only if a certain *Yuvraaj* hadn't happened.



KNOTTY AFFAIR

In seriously *filmi* style, Sanjay Dutt and Manyata, after months of ho-hum-hoing about their relationship, tied the knot at a friend's house. Till a day before, the actor vehemently denied that he was getting married, much like his relationship. Maybe he really was unaware. After all neither of his two sisters—Priya and Namrata—was invited. But the drama didn't end there. A former husband appeared, claiming Manyata—earlier Dilnawaz—was still married to him. Rumours of a baby followed, as did reconciliation with Dutt's daughter even as the sisters decided to maintain their distance while living in the same building. And all this, in under one year. In case you are wondering, Dutt did miraculously find time to shoot as well.

YOGESH SHARMA

